



News

Trump DOJ Claims It Handed Judge Epstein FBI Notes on Disturbing Trump Allegations

Judge Emmet Sullivan ordered Attorney General Todd Blanche to submit unredacted FBI notes and support disputed victim redactions, while a temporary appellate pause now blocks foreign-language file review.

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By [Brett Meiselas](#) and [CutterStudios.AI](#)



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- DOJ says it complied with court orders, but publicly disclosed neither submitted materials nor supporting evidence.
- Judge Sullivan will review handwritten FBI notes and documentation justifying three disputed victim-related redactions.
- Appeals court temporarily paused foreign-language file production while considering DOJ’s request for a longer stay.

According to a Justice Department lawyer, Attorney General Todd Blanche has turned over to a federal judge unredacted handwritten FBI notes memorializing four interviews with a woman who alleges Donald Trump sexually and physically abused her when she was 13 to 15 years old.

On Friday, Katie Phang said DOJ lawyer Andrew Block indicated by email that Blanche had complied with U.S. District Judge Emmet G. Sullivan’s September 16 order, which required the notes to be submitted by September 24 at 11 a.m. Eastern.



Sidebar with Katie Phang
AG Blanche Admits He Turned Over Unredacted Epste...



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Sullivan also ordered Blanche to provide evidence supporting the DOJ’s claim that redactions in three separate Epstein-related emails actually protect victims. But the Justice Department did not file a public notice detailing its compliance, leaving unclear exactly what supporting material Blanche provided for those disputed redactions.

The development puts the original handwritten FBI notes directly in Sullivan’s hands. The judge will review both redacted and unredacted versions and determine whether the Trump regime’s proposed redactions are justified before the records are released publicly.

Meanwhile, Blanche is fighting another part of Sullivan’s order at the D.C. Circuit, where he is seeking a stay of the requirement that DOJ begin reviewing and producing foreign-language Epstein materials that have never been publicly released.

The D.C. Circuit has temporarily paused that requirement while it considers Blanche’s request for a longer stay. The court has not ruled that the records may be withheld.

The latest developments come after months of clashes between Blanche and Sullivan over the Trump Justice Department’s handling of the Epstein Files Transparency Act, including

Sullivan Rejected DOJ’s Claim That FBI Notes Were Duplicative

One part of the dispute centers on handwritten FBI notes underlying four FD-302 interview reports. The notes memorialize interviews with a woman who alleged that Donald Trump sexually and physically abused her when she was 13 to 15 years old.

Blanche had argued that the handwritten notes could remain withheld because they were substantially similar to the typed reports and because manually redacting them would be difficult.

Sullivan rejected that position in his September 16 order. The judge found that the department’s own review protocol did not authorize withholding documents merely because they were substantially similar and that the handwritten notes were not duplicates of the FD-302 reports.

“The underlying handwritten notes are not duplicates of the FD-302 interview reports.”

U.S. District Judge Emmet G. Sullivan

The judge ordered Blanche to provide both redacted and unredacted versions of the notes for private review by 11 a.m. Eastern on September 24.

Phang said Sullivan will now review those versions himself. Blanche was still required to propose redactions necessary to protect victims’ confidential information, but Sullivan will determine whether those proposed redactions are justified before any version of the handwritten notes is released publicly.

In other words, the Trump regime does not get the final word on what the public can see. The judge does.

Phang also stressed why the handwritten notes matter even if the corresponding FD-302 reports purport to summarize their contents: the notes are the original source documents. The existence of a later FBI report, she argues, does not eliminate the DOJ’s obligation to comply with the Epstein Files Transparency Act.

The Judge Demanded Proof Behind Three Victim Redactions

M Trump DOJ Claims It Handed Judge Epstein FBI Notes on Disturbing Trump Allegations that Redacted Names in Three Epstein-Related Emails Belong to Victims. The documents carry Bates numbers EFTA01187999, EFTA02504630, and EFTA01022356.

The three emails include communications involving Jeffrey Epstein and redacted correspondents. One references a 19-year-old woman connected to a Paris modeling agency; another discusses young women; and a third, dated September 21, 2018, discusses someone from Lithuania whose identifying information is redacted.

The court did not simply order those names released. Instead, Sullivan ordered Blanche to provide corroborating documentation showing that the people whose identities were concealed actually qualify for victim protections.

That distinction matters. The Justice Department may protect victims' identities under the law. But Sullivan is requiring the department to substantiate its claim that these particular redactions actually serve that purpose.

Phang said Block's September 25 email led her to believe Blanche had complied with Sullivan's order, but she emphasized that the public still cannot see what that compliance consisted of.

Maybe Blanche provided corroborating documentation for one of the three disputed documents. Maybe he provided it for two. Maybe he provided it for all three. Or, as Phang noted, it remains possible he provided none.

Without a public notice of compliance detailing what was submitted, Phang said she and the public are left to wonder exactly what Blanche turned over.

Sullivan will now review whatever corroborating material the DOJ submitted and determine whether the disputed redactions are justified.

Blanche Tried To Pause the Foreign-Language Files

The unfinished fight extends beyond the FBI notes and the three emails.

Sullivan's injunction also required the Justice Department to begin reviewing and producing foreign-language materials that may be responsive to the Epstein Files Transparency Act.

According to Phang, not a single foreign-language Epstein-file document had been publicly produced as of September 25.

And nobody outside the government appears to know the scope of what remains unseen. Phang said the material could include documents, emails, travel records, photographs, videos containing foreign-language text, or other records. Nor is it publicly known whether

M Trump DOJ Claims It Handed Judge Epstein FBI Notes on Disturbing Trump Allegations, or Substantially More.

That uncertainty raises another question about the Trump regime’s claim that it has already satisfied its disclosure obligations: Are those foreign-language records part of the millions of Epstein-file materials the DOJ has acknowledged withholding as duplicative or nonresponsive, or do they represent an additional universe of records that has never been publicly accounted for?

Blanche’s explanation for not producing the material was that first-level reviewers could not practicably review foreign-language records. Phang argues that practical difficulty is not an exception contained in the Epstein Files Transparency Act.

Blanche asked Sullivan to stay the portion of his September 16 order requiring the government to begin reviewing and producing those records.

Sullivan declined to give Blanche the stay he wanted, but gave the DOJ a brief opportunity to seek relief from the U.S. Court of Appeals for the District of Columbia Circuit.

Blanche did exactly that.

The D.C. Circuit subsequently granted an administrative stay, temporarily pausing Sullivan’s September 24 deadline requiring the DOJ to begin the foreign-language review and production while the appeals court considers Blanche’s request for a substantive stay.

That is an important distinction. The appeals court has not ruled that the Trump regime may permanently withhold the foreign-language records or that Blanche is correct on the merits. The administrative stay simply preserves the status quo while the court considers whether to grant the broader stay he requested.

Phang’s opposition to that request was due Friday at 5 p.m. Eastern, with Blanche permitted to file a reply by September 29 at 4 p.m. The appeals court can then decide whether the foreign-language portion of Sullivan’s order remains frozen while the litigation continues.

DOJ Had Already Blown Another Deadline

The latest fight comes after the Justice Department previously missed a major deadline in Phang’s lawsuit.

The DOJ missed its June 26 deadline to answer Phang’s complaint, did not seek an extension before the deadline passed, and later asked Sullivan to freeze the case’s deadlines.

Sullivan rejected that request on September 16, finding that Blanche had not provided an adequate justification for missing the deadline and had failed to address key factors

The judge ordered Blanche to answer the complaint by September 24, certify the administrative record by October 1, and produce that record to Phang by October 15.

The missed deadline came after Sullivan had already granted Phang a preliminary injunction in June, finding she was likely to prevail on claims that the Justice Department had failed to meet disclosure obligations under the Epstein Files Transparency Act.

Sullivan’s June opinion also found that Blanche had conceded Phang’s merits arguments in the preliminary-injunction litigation by failing to substantively respond to them.

Then, on September 16, Sullivan found the DOJ had again failed to respond, this time to Phang’s motion seeking an answer and the administrative record.

COURT DEADLINES

DOJ Never Filed Notice C...	Todd Blanche's Epstein R...	Emmet Sullivar
		
DOJ Never Filed Notice Confirming Epstein Notes Production 65/100	Todd Blanche’s Epstein Redaction Proof Remains A Mystery 80/100	Emmet Sullivan Control Become Public 68/100

The DOJ Called Its Release Complete. The Fight Is Far From Over.

The broader dispute exposes the gulf between what the Justice Department says it has already accomplished and what Sullivan has ordered it to do.

In January, the Justice Department declared that its release of nearly 3.5 million pages completed its production obligations under the Epstein Files Transparency Act. The department said it had released more than 2,000 videos and 180,000 images after deploying more than 500 attorneys and reviewers.

But Sullivan later found that Phang was likely to succeed on claims challenging the department’s handling of specific redactions, handwritten FBI interview notes, foreign-language materials, and the required redaction log.

Now the litigation is moving on multiple fronts.

M Trump DOJ Claims It Handed Judge Epstein FBI Notes on Disturbing Trump Allegations to Victim Reduction Claims. The D.C. Circuit is considering whether DiBiase can continue delaying the review and production of foreign-language materials. And additional deadlines involving the administrative record are approaching.

What remains unresolved is the question at the heart of Phang’s lawsuit: whether the Trump regime actually disclosed everything Congress required it to disclose, or whether potentially significant portions of the Epstein files remain hidden from public view.

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Brett Meiselas
Co-Founder of MeidasTouch



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